Your Word Is Your Wand

FLORENCE SCOVEL SHINN

Your Word *is your* Wand

ANNOTATED EDITION

The classic book of affirmations
with modern commentary and a 30-day practice

INTRODUCTION AND NOTES BY ANDREAS RUPP

Your Word Is Your Wand (Annotated)
The Classic Book of Affirmations with Modern Commentary and a 30-Day Practice

The text of *Your Word Is Your Wand* by Florence Scovel Shinn (1871–1940) was first published in 1928 and is in the public domain. This edition follows the 1928 text; spelling and wording are kept, obvious printing errors are corrected.

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Please note: This book is about a spiritual practice. It is not medical, psychological, financial or legal advice. Affirmations can go alongside professional help, never instead of it. If you are ill or in crisis, please see a doctor or a qualified professional. In an emergency, call 911 (US) or 999 (UK).

Edited by Andreas Rupp

Death and life are in the power of the tongue.

PROVERBS 18:21

Contents

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

How to Use This Book 9
About Florence Scovel Shinn 11
The World of New Thought 13
A Note on This Edition 15

YOUR WORD IS YOUR WAND

Your Word Is Your Wand 19
Success 23
Prosperity 32
Happiness 36
Love 41
Marriage 44
Forgiveness 47
Words of Wisdom 50
Faith 55
Loss 63
Debt 66
Sales 69
Interviews 72
Guidance 74
Protection 77
Memory 79
Divine Design 81
Health 85
Eyes 88
Anaemia 91
Ears 93
Rheumatism 95
False Growths 97

Heart Disease 99
Animals 101
Elements 103
Journey 106
Miscellaneous 108
Conclusion 116

PUTTING IT INTO PRACTICE

The 30-Day Practice 119
Affirmation Finder 151

AFTER THE BOOK

Afterword: Speaking a New Story 153
Further Reading 155

How to Use This Book

Florence Scovel Shinn believed that words do things. In her view, a sentence spoken with conviction is not just a description of what you hope for. It is a seed, a tool, a "wand" you hold over a situation to help change it. She called these sentences affirmations, or statements, and she gave her students short, vivid ones they could repeat until the words sank below the surface of the mind and began to shape their feelings, their choices and, as she saw it, their circumstances.

This edition keeps her book exactly as she wrote it. Each of her chapters appears in full, untouched. After every chapter you will find three new sections written for this edition:

- **Reflection** explains the chapter in plain, modern words, retells one or two of her stories, and points out the Bible passages she quotes or echoes.
- **Practice** gives you one concrete exercise to try.
- **Key Affirmation** pulls out a single statement from the chapter, in her exact words, for you to carry with you.

At the end of the book you will find a 30-Day Practice that walks through her teaching one day at a time, and an Affirmation Finder that points you to the right page when a particular worry shows up in your life.

A few simple tips will help you get the most from her method:

Say it out loud. Shinn called it the *spoken* word for a reason. Hearing your own voice say something hopeful is different from thinking

it silently.

Write it down. Copy your affirmation onto a card, a sticky note or the first page of a journal. Handwriting slows you down and helps the words land.

Repeat it. One of her students repeated an affirmation "hundreds of times." You do not need to count, but repetition is the heart of the practice.

Pair it with action. Shinn constantly told her students to "dig ditches," meaning to prepare for the good they were asking for. An affirmation is not a substitute for making the phone call, sending the application or booking the appointment. It is the inner side of the same effort.

Be patient and kind with yourself. Some days the words will feel true; other days they will feel like a stretch. Both are normal. Keep going, notice small shifts, and let the practice be a companion rather than a test.

About Florence Scovel Shinn

Florence Scovel was born in 1871 in Camden, New Jersey, across the Delaware River from Philadelphia. Long before she was known for teaching about faith and the spoken word, she was known for her drawings.

She studied art at the Pennsylvania Academy of the Fine Arts in Philadelphia, one of the oldest and most respected art schools in the United States. Philadelphia had a lively circle of young artists at the time, and among them was the painter Everett Shinn. The two married in 1898, and their life together centered on New York City, where both worked in the busy world of magazine and book illustration.

New York at the turn of the twentieth century was hungry for pictures. Magazines and publishers relied on illustrators to bring stories and articles to life, and Florence found work drawing for both. Everett Shinn, meanwhile, became known as one of the realist painters who portrayed everyday city life.

The marriage did not last. Florence and Everett Shinn divorced in 1912. It is not hard to imagine that this painful chapter shaped her later teaching. Her books return again and again to fear of loss, to the "other woman," to resentment and to forgiveness, and she writes about them with the sympathy of someone who knew those feelings from the inside.

In the years that followed, Shinn turned more and more toward spiritual study. She became part of the New Thought movement, which taught that the mind and the spirit play a central role in shaping human experience, and that prayer and right thinking can bring practical help in daily life. She began to teach classes and give talks in New York, and she

became a popular lecturer with a loyal following. She also worked one-on-one with people who came to her with problems about money, work, love and health, "speaking the word" for them, as she put it.

Her teaching style was unusual. Where many spiritual writers of her day were abstract and solemn, Shinn was brisk, funny and full of stories. She talked about tearooms and candy shops, lost pencils, rented rooms, Chinese cabinets and snowstorms. She liked slang and catchy phrases. She drew on the Bible constantly, especially the words of Jesus and the Psalms, but she also borrowed from the movies, from popular sayings and from card games.

In 1925 she published her first book, *The Game of Life and How to Play It*. She brought it out herself, at a time when self-publishing was far less common than it is today. The book found readers, and it has stayed in print ever since. Three years later, in 1928, she published *Your Word Is Your Wand*, the book you hold now. It is shorter and more practical than the first one: a handbook of affirmations, grouped by subject, with brief stories to show how she believed they worked. She refers to the earlier book often, and the two were clearly meant to be read together.

Her third book, *The Secret Door to Success*, appeared in 1940. That same year, on October 17, 1940, Florence Scovel Shinn died in New York.

Her work did not end with her death. Notes and material from her teaching were gathered into a fourth book, *The Power of the Spoken Word*, published in 1945. Together, these four short books have kept her voice alive for nearly a century, passed from reader to reader by people who found her bright, plain-spoken faith helpful in hard times.

She was an artist first, and in a sense she remained one. Her books are full of pictures: the purse "crammed, jammed" with money, the door "nailed back," the lion on the path that turns out to be a friendly dog. She knew that the mind responds to images, and she painted them with words.

The World of New Thought

To understand Shinn, it helps to know the movement she belonged to. "New Thought" is the name given to a loose family of teachers, churches and writers that grew up in the United States in the second half of the nineteenth century.

Many trace its roots to Phineas Parkhurst Quimby, a clockmaker and healer in Maine who worked in the 1840s to 1860s. Quimby came to believe that many illnesses were tied to people's beliefs and fears, and that changing those beliefs could bring relief. Several of the people he worked with went on to teach and write about his ideas.

Another strong influence was Ralph Waldo Emerson and the Transcendentalist writers of New England. Emerson taught that a divine spirit runs through nature and through every person, and that each of us can trust the inner voice of that spirit. New Thought teachers took this idea and made it practical: if the divine is within, then prayer, thought and speech can be ways of working with it.

By the late 1800s, several groups had formed around these ideas. Unity, founded by Charles and Myrtle Fillmore in Kansas City, blended New Thought with a warm, Bible-centered Christianity. Divine Science took shape in the American West, with women among its leading founders and teachers. A little later, Religious Science grew out of the work of Ernest Holmes in Los Angeles in the 1920s. These groups differed in style, but they shared a hopeful conviction: that God is good, that God is present everywhere, and that human beings can align their thinking with that goodness.

The 1920s, when Shinn was writing, were a high point for these ideas. Cities were growing, the economy was booming for many, and people were eager for practical spirituality that spoke to work, money and personal happiness, not only to the life to come. Lecture halls in New York and elsewhere filled with people who wanted to learn how to "demonstrate" good in their own lives.

Shinn's particular gift was to make all of this plain and memorable. Her short, catchy affirmations and down-to-earth stories helped carry New Thought ideas into the wider world. Much of the later popular literature on positive thinking, affirmations and "manifesting" echoes themes she was teaching a century ago, often without naming her. Reading her directly lets you meet those ideas at one of their sources, in her own lively voice, along with the strong Christian faith that framed them.

A Note on This Edition

The text of *Your Word Is Your Wand* in this book follows the original 1928 edition. Shinn's wording, punctuation and spelling have been kept as she wrote them, including the British spelling of "Anaemia" and her own use of capital letters for words such as "Divine Mind" and "Spirit." Only obvious printing errors have been corrected. Her references to page numbers in *The Game of Life and How to Play It* point to the edition of that book available in her day and may not match modern printings.

Some of her language is of its time. She uses "man" to mean all people, women and men alike. She quotes the King James Bible, often from memory and sometimes loosely. Some of her stories reflect the social attitudes of the 1920s, especially about marriage and the roles of husbands and wives. These have been left as they are and are discussed gently in the notes.

Shinn makes strong claims about health and money. This edition presents those claims as her teaching, not as promises. Affirmations can be a meaningful spiritual and emotional practice, but they are not a replacement for medical care or for sound financial decisions. Please see a doctor for any health concern, and seek qualified advice about money.

Everything outside Shinn's original chapters, including the introductions, reflections, practices, the 30-Day Practice, the Affirmation Finder and the afterword, is new material written for this edition.

Your Word Is Your Wand

THE TEXT OF 1928 · WITH NOTES

CHAPTER

I

Your Word Is Your Wand

MAN'S WORD is his wand filled with magic and power!

Jesus Christ emphasized the power of the word; "By thy words thou shalt be justified and by thy words thou shalt be condemned," and "death and life are in power of the tongue."

So man has power to change an unhappy condition by waving over it the wand of his word.

In the place of sorrow appears joy, in the place of sickness appears health, in the place of lack appears plenty.

For example: A woman came for a treatment for prosperity. She possessed just two dollars in the world.

I said: "We bless the two dollars and know that you have the magic purse of the Spirit; it can never be depleted; as money goes out, immediately money comes in, under grace in perfect ways.

I see it always crammed, jammed with money: yellow bills, green bills, pink checks, blue checks, white checks, gold, silver and currency. I see it bulging with abundance!"

She replied: "I feel my bag heavy with money," and was so filled with faith that she gave me one of her dollars as a love offering. I did not dare refuse it and see lack for her, as it was important that I hold the picture of plenty.

Shortly afterwards she was made a gift of six thousand dollars. Fearless faith and the spoken word brought it to pass.

The affirmation of the magic purse is very powerful, as it brings a vivid picture to the mind. It is impossible not to see your purse or wallet filled with money when using the words, "crammed, jammed."

The imaging faculty is the creative faculty and it is important to choose words which bring a flash of the fulfillment of the demand.

Never force a picture by visualizing; let the Divine Idea flash into your conscious mind; then the student is working according to the Divine Design.

(See *The Game of Life and How to Play It*, pages 75-84.)

Jesus Christ said: "Ye shall know the Truth and the Truth shall make you free."

This means that man must know the Truth of every situation which confronts him.

There is no Truth in lack or limitation. *He waves over it the wand of His Word and the wilderness rejoices and blossoms as the rose.*

Fear, doubt, anxiety, anger, resentment pull down the cells of the body, shock the nervous system and are the causes of disease and disaster.

Happiness and health must be earned by absolute control of the emotional nature.

Power moves but is never moved. When man stands calm and serene, has a good appetite, feels contented and happy when appearances are against him, he has reached mastery. Then he has power to "rebuke the winds and the waves," to control conditions.

His word is his wand and he transmutes apparent failure into success.

He knows his universal supply is endless and immediate and all his needs manifest instantly on the external.

For example, a woman at sea awoke in the morning hearing the fog-horns blowing. A dense fog had settled on the ocean with no apparent signs of clearing. She immediately spoke the word: "There are no fogs in Divine Mind, so let the fog be lifted! I give thanks for the sun!"

Soon the sun came out, for man has dominion over "the elements—over all created things."

Every man has power to lift the fog in his life. It may be a fog of lack of money, love, happiness or health.

Give thanks for the sun!

✦

REFLECTION

This opening chapter gives the whole book its title and its central idea: the words you speak about your life carry weight. Shinn grounds this in two Bible passages she runs together, "By thy words thou shalt be justified, and by thy words thou shalt be condemned" (Matthew 12:37) and "Death and life are in the power of the tongue" (Proverbs 18:21).

She tells of a woman who came to her with only two dollars (about $40 today). Instead of agreeing that things were hopeless, Shinn blessed the money and painted a playful picture of a purse "crammed, jammed" with bills and checks. Shinn reports that the woman later received a gift of six thousand dollars, roughly $110,000 today. In another story, a woman at sea speaks to a heavy fog and gives thanks for the sun.

Notice what Shinn is really teaching here: choose words that create a vivid, hopeful picture, and stay calm when "appearances are against" you. She also quotes "Ye shall know the truth, and the truth shall make you free" (John 8:32) and echoes Isaiah 35:1, where the desert "shall blossom as the rose." For a reader today, the invitation is simple: notice the fog in your own life, and practice speaking about it with hope instead of dread.

PRACTICE

1. Name one "fog" in your life right now: a worry about money, love, work or health.
2. Write down the sentence you usually say about it ("I'll never...", "It's always...").

3. Cross it out and write a hopeful replacement in the present tense.
4. Say the new sentence aloud three times this morning and three times tonight.
5. Choose one small, practical step toward clearing that fog and do it today.

KEY AFFIRMATION

There are no fogs in Divine Mind, so let the fog be lifted! I give thanks for the sun!

MY OWN WORDS

CHAPTER

II

Success

THERE ARE certain words or pictures which impress the subconscious mind.

For example: A man called asking me to speak the word for his right work.

I gave him the statement: "Behold I have set before thee the open door of destiny and no man shall shut it!"

It didn't seem to make much impression, so I was inspired to add: "And no man shall shut it for it is *nailed back!*"

The man was electrified and went out walking on air. Within a few weeks he was called to a distant city to fill a wonderful position which came about in a miraculous way.

I give another example of a woman who fearlessly followed a "hunch."

She was working for a small salary when she read my book, *The Game of Life and How to Play It*. The thought came in a flash, to start in business for herself and open a Tearoom and Candy Shop.

The idea staggered her at first, but it persisted, so she boldly went forth and procured a shop and assistants.

She "spoke the word for supply," for she did not have money to back her enterprise. It came in miraculous ways, and the shop opened!

From the first day it was filled with people, and now it is "crammed jammed"; they stand in line and wait.

One day, being a holiday, her assistants became gloomy and said they could not expect to do much business. My student, however, replied that God was her supply and *every* day was a *good* day.

In the afternoon an old friend came in to see the shop and bought a two pound box of candy. He gave her a check and when she looked at it she found it was for a hundred dollars. So it was indeed a good day! One hundred dollars for a box of candy!

She says every morning she enters the shop with wonder and gives thanks that she had the *fearless faith that wins!*

AFFIRMATIONS

The decks are now cleared for Divine Action and my own comes to me under grace in a magical way.

✦

I now let go of worn-out conditions and worn-out things. Divine order is established in my mind, body and affairs. "Behold, I make all things new."

✦

My seeming impossible good now comes to pass, the unexpected now happens!

✦

The "four winds of success" now blow to me my own. From North, South, East and West comes my endless good.

✦

The Christ in me is risen, I now fulfill my destiny.

✦

Endless good now comes to me in endless ways.

✦

I clap my cymbals and rejoice, for Jehovah goes
before me making clear, easy and successful my way!

✦

I give thanks for my whirlwind success.
I sweep all before me for I work with the
Spirit and follow the Divine Plan of my life.

✦

My Spiritual Sporting blood is up! I
am more than equal to this situation.

✦

I am awake to my good, and gather
in the harvest of endless opportunities.

✦

I am harmonious, poised and magnetic.
I now draw to myself my own. My
power is God's power and is irresistible!

✦

Divine order is now established in my mind, body and affairs.
I see clearly and act quickly and my greatest
expectations come to pass in a miraculous way.

✦

There is no competition on the Spiritual plane.
What is rightfully mine is given me under grace.

✦

I have within me an undiscovered country, which is revealed to me now, in the name of Jesus Christ.

✦

Behold! I have set before thee the open door of Destiny and no man shall shut it, for it is nailed back.

✦

The tide of Destiny has turned and everything comes my way.

✦

I banish the past and now live in the wonderful now, where happy surprises come to me each day.

✦

There are no lost opportunities in Divine Mind, as one door shut another door opened.

✦

I have a magical work in a magical way, I give magical service for magical pay.

✦

The genius within me is now released. I now fulfill my destiny.

✦

I make friends with hindrances and every obstacle becomes a stepping-stone. Every-thing in the Universe, visible and invisible, is working to bring to me my own.

✦

I give thanks that the walls of Jericho fall down and all lack, limitation and failure are wiped out of my consciousness in the name of Jesus Christ.

✦

I am now on the royal road of Success, Happiness and Abundance, all the traffic goes my way.

✦

I will not weary of well-doing, for when I least expect it I shall reap.

✦

Jehovah goes before me and the battle is won!
All enemy thoughts are wiped out.
I am victorious in the name of Jesus Christ.

✦

There are no obstacles in Divine Mind, therefore, there is nothing to obstruct my good.

✦

All obstacles now vanish from my pathway.
Doors fly open, gates are lifted and I enter the Kingdom of fulfillment, under grace.

✦

Rhythm, harmony and balance are now established in my mind, body and affairs.

✦

New fields of Divine activity now open for me and these fields are white with the harvest.

✦

Man's will is powerless to interfere with God's will.
God's will is now done in my mind, body and affairs.

✦

God's plan for me is permanent and cannot be budged.

I am true to my heavenly vision.

✦

"The Divine Plan of my life now takes shape in definite, concrete experiences leading to my heart's desire."

✦

I now draw from the Universal Substance, with irresistible power and determination, that which is mine by Divine Right.

✦

I do not resist this situation. I put it in the hands of Infinite Love and Wisdom. Let the Divine idea now come to pass.

✦

My good now flows to me in a steady, unbroken, ever-increasing stream of success, happiness and abundance.

✦

There are no lost opportunities in the Kingdom. As one door shuts another door opens.

✦

"There is nothing to fear for there is no power to hurt." I walk up to the lion on my pathway and find an angel in armor, and victory in the name of Jesus Christ.

✦

I am in perfect harmony with the working of the law. I stand aside and let Infinite Intelligence make easy and successful my way.

✦

The ground I am on is holy ground; The ground I am on is successful ground.

✦

New fields of Divine Activity now open for me.
Unexpected doors fly open, unexpected channels are free.

✦

What God has done for others He can do for me and more!

✦

I am as necessary to God as He is to me, for
I am the channel to bring His plan to pass.

✦

I do not limit God by seeing limitation in myself.
With God and myself all things are possible.

✦

Giving precedes receiving and my gifts
to others precede God's gifts to me.

✦

Every man is a golden link in the chain of my good.

✦

My poise is built upon a rock. I see clearly and act quickly.

✦

God cannot fail, so I cannot fail. "The
warrior within me" has already won.

✦

Thy Kingdom come in me, Thy
will be done in me and my affairs.

REFLECTION

Shinn opens this chapter by pointing out that certain words and images reach the deeper mind better than others. A man asked her to pray for his right work. She gave him a line drawn from Revelation 3:8, "I have set before thee an open door, and no man can shut it." It didn't seem to land, so she added that the door was "nailed back." That vivid detail, she says, electrified him, and soon he was offered a fine position in another city.

Her second story is about a woman earning a small salary who had a "hunch" to open a tearoom and candy shop. Scared but persistent, she went ahead, and Shinn reports that the shop became crowded with customers. On a slow holiday, the owner insisted every day was a good day, and an old friend paid a hundred dollars (roughly $1,900 today) for a box of candy.

The long list of affirmations that follows draws on many biblical images: "Behold, I make all things new" (Revelation 21:5), the walls of Jericho falling (Joshua 6), not growing "weary in well doing" (Galatians 6:9), and fields "white already to harvest" (John 4:35). The thread through all of them is courage. Success, in Shinn's view, comes from fearless faith joined to bold action, not from competing with anyone else.

PRACTICE

Pick one affirmation from this chapter that gives you a jolt of energy when you read it. Write it on a card and keep it where you work. Then list three "hunches" you have had about your work or calling that you have not acted on. Choose the smallest one and take a first, concrete step toward it this week, such as a phone call, a sketch, a conversation or a bit of research.

KEY AFFIRMATION

I make friends with hindrances and
every obstacle becomes a stepping-stone.

MY OWN WORDS

CHAPTER

III

Prosperity

(See also *The Game of Life and How to Play It.*)

Man comes into the world financed by God, with all that he desires or requires already on his pathway.

This supply is released through faith and the *Spoken Word.*

"If thou canst believe, all things are possible."

For example: A woman came to me one day, to tell me of her experience in using an affirmation she had read in my book, *The Game of Life and How to Play It.*

She was without experience but desired a good position on the stage. She took the affirmation: "Infinite Spirit, open the way for my great abundance. I am an irresistible magnet for all that belongs to me by Divine Right."

She was given a very important part in a successful opera.

She said: "It was a miracle, due to that affirmation, which I repeated hundreds of times."

AFFIRMATIONS

I now draw from the abundance of the spheres my immediate and endless supply.

All channels are free!
All doors are open!

✦

I now release the gold-mine within me. I am linked with an endless golden stream of prosperity which comes to me under grace in perfect ways.

✦

Goodness and mercy shall follow me all the days of my life and I shall dwell in the house of abundance forever.

✦

My God is a God of plenty and I now receive all that I desire or require, and more.

✦

All that is mine by Divine Right is now released and reaches me in great avalanches of abundance, under grace in miraculous ways.

✦

My supply is endless, inexhaustible and immediate and comes to me under grace in perfect ways.

✦

All channels are free and all doors fly open for my immediate and endless, Divinely Designed supply.

✦

My ships come in over a calm sea, under grace in perfect ways.

✦

I give thanks that the millions which are mine by Divine Right, now pour in and pile up under grace in perfect ways.

✦

Unexpected doors fly open, unexpected channels are free, and endless avalanches of abundance are poured out upon me, under grace in perfect ways.

✦

I spend money under direct inspiration wisely and fearlessly, knowing my supply is endless and immediate.

✦

I am fearless in letting money go out, knowing God is my immediate and endless supply.

✦

REFLECTION

Shinn begins with one of her boldest statements: every person "comes into the world financed by God," with what they need already on their path. In her teaching, this supply is released through faith and the spoken word. She quotes Jesus in Mark 9:23: "If thou canst believe, all things are possible."

Her example is a woman with no stage experience who wanted a good role in the theater. She repeated an affirmation from Shinn's earlier book "hundreds of times," and she later won an important part in a successful opera. The woman herself called it a miracle.

The affirmations that follow are full of abundance imagery: ships coming in over a calm sea, avalanches of plenty, an echo of Psalm 23:6 ("Goodness and mercy shall follow me all the days of my life"). Some readers will love these images; others may find talk of "millions" uncomfortable. It helps to read them as Shinn's way of breaking the habit of thinking in terms of scarcity.

This chapter is not a promise of wealth. Notice, though, that two of its affirmations are about spending money "wisely and fearlessly." Shinn's ideal is a calm, generous relationship with money, free of panic and grasping. Today, that might mean pairing these words with a clear budget, honest work and good financial advice.

PRACTICE

1. Look at your bank balance or bills without flinching, and simply bless what is there.
2. Choose one affirmation from this chapter and say it aloud before you open your banking app each day this week.
3. Make one wise money decision: set up a small savings transfer, cancel an unused subscription, or ask for help with a budget.
4. Notice how your feelings about money shift when fear is not in the driver's seat.

KEY AFFIRMATION

I spend money under direct inspiration wisely and fearlessly, knowing my supply is endless and immediate.

MY OWN WORDS

CHAPTER

IV

Happiness

IN THAT wonderful moving picture, "The Thief of Bagdad," we were told in letters of light that *happiness must be earned!*

It is earned through perfect control of the emotional nature.

There can be no happiness where there is fear, apprehension or dread. With *perfect faith in God* comes a feeling of *security* and *happiness.*

When man *knows* that there is an *invincible power* that protects him and all that he loves, and brings to him every righteous desire of the heart, he relaxes all nervous tension and is happy and satisfied.

He is undisturbed by adverse appearances, knowing that *Infinite Intelligence* is protecting his interests and utilizing every situation to bring his good to pass.

"I will make a way in the wilderness and rivers in a desert."

Uneasy lies the head that wears a frown. Anger, resentment, ill-will, jealousy and revenge rob man of his happiness and bring sickness, failure and poverty in their wake.

Resentment has ruined more homes than drink and killed more people than war.

For example: There was a woman who was healthy and happy and married to a man she loved.

The man died and left part of his estate to a relative. The woman was filled with resentment. She lost weight, was unable to do her work, developed gall-stones and became very ill.

A metaphysician called upon her one day. He said: "Woman, see what hate and resentment have done to you; they have caused hard stones to form in your body and only forgiveness and good-will can cure you."

The woman saw the Truth of the statement. She became harmonious and forgiving and regained her splendid health.

AFFIRMATIONS

I am now deluged with the happiness that was planned for me in the Beginning. My barns are full, my cup flows over with joy.

✦

My endless good now comes to me in endless ways.

✦

I have a wonderful joy in a wonderful way, and my wonderful joy has come to stay.

✦

Happy surprises come to me each day. "I look with wonder at that which is before me."

✦

I walk boldly up to the lion on my pathway and find it is a friendly airedale.

✦

I am harmonious, happy, radiant; detached from the tyranny of fear.

✦

My happiness is built upon a rock.
It is mine now and for all eternity.

✦

My good now flows to me in a steady
unbroken, ever-increasing stream of happiness.

✦

My happiness is God's affair, therefore, no one can interfere.

✦

As I am one with God I am now one with my heart's desire.

✦

I give thanks for my permanent happiness, my permanent
health, my permanent wealth, my permanent love.

✦

I am harmonious, happy and Divinely magnetic,
and now draw to me my ships over a calm sea.

✦

God's ideas for me are perfect and permanent.

✦

My heart's desire is a perfect idea in Divine
Mind, incorruptible and indestructible, and now
comes to pass, under grace in a magical way.

✦

REFLECTION

Shinn borrows a line from the 1924 silent film *The Thief of Bagdad*: happiness must be earned. In her view, we earn it by learning to manage our emotions, especially fear, dread and resentment. When we truly trust that a loving power

is protecting us and those we love, she says, nervous tension relaxes and contentment can take its place. She quotes God's promise in Isaiah 43:19: "I will even make a way in the wilderness, and rivers in the desert."

She plays on a line from Shakespeare's *Henry IV*, "Uneasy lies the head that wears a crown," turning it into "the head that wears a frown." Then she makes a striking claim: resentment has ruined more homes than drink.

Her story is about a woman whose husband died and left part of his estate to a relative. Consumed by resentment, the woman became very ill. A visitor told her that her bitterness was hurting her, and when she chose forgiveness, Shinn reports, her health returned. Whatever we make of the medical side of that story, many people know from experience how heavy resentment feels to carry. The chapter's lighter affirmations, like the lion on the path that turns out to be "a friendly airedale" (a breed of terrier), invite us to meet our fears with humor.

PRACTICE

Write down one resentment you are still carrying, however small. Next to it, write what holding on to it is costing you in sleep, mood, energy or relationships. Then say, "I release this and choose peace." Each time the old feeling returns this week, gently repeat the chapter's key affirmation and turn your attention to one thing you are glad about.

KEY AFFIRMATION

I am harmonious, happy, radiant;
detached from the tyranny of fear.

MY OWN WORDS

CHAPTER

V

Love

WITH LOVE usually comes terrific fear. Nearly every woman comes into the world with a mythical woman in the back of her mind who is to rob her of her love.

She has been called "the other woman." Of course it comes from woman's belief in duality. So long as she visualizes interference, it will come.

It is usually very difficult for a woman to see herself loved by the man she loves, so these affirmations are to impress the truth of the situation upon her subconscious mind, for *in reality there is only oneness.*

(See *The Game of Life and How to Play It*, pages 56-65.)

AFFIRMATIONS

As I am one with God, the Undivided One, I am one with my undivided love and undivided happiness.

✦

The Light of the Christ within now wipes out all fear, doubt, anger and resentment. God's love pours through me, an irresistible magnetic current. I see only perfection and draw to me my own.

✦

Divine Love, through me, now dissolves all seeming obstacles and makes clear, easy and successful my way.

✦

I love everyone and everyone loves me. My apparent enemy becomes my friend, a golden link in the chain of my good.

✦

I am at peace with myself and with the whole world. I love everyone and everyone loves me.

The flood gates of my good now open.

✦

REFLECTION

This short chapter speaks to a fear Shinn says nearly every woman carries: the fear of losing love to "the other woman." Writing more than a decade after her own divorce, she speaks with obvious feeling. Her diagnosis is spiritual. In her view, the fear comes from believing in "duality," in separation and competition, when in truth there is only oneness with God. As long as we keep picturing someone coming between us and our love, she warns, we give that picture power.

Rather than telling stories here, Shinn offers affirmations meant to replace that fearful picture. They speak of an "undivided" love, of God's love flowing through us like a magnetic current, and of the apparent enemy becoming a friend.

Her language is shaped by the 1920s and focuses on women and husbands, but the heart of the chapter applies to anyone. Jealousy and insecurity usually grow when we rehearse the worst. Shinn invites us to rehearse love instead.

Modern readers might pair these affirmations with honest conversations and healthy boundaries, since peace in a relationship also depends on how two people actually treat each other.

PRACTICE

For one week, notice whenever you imagine a rival, a rejection or a loss in a relationship. Each time, pause and quietly say the chapter's key affirmation. Then write one sentence describing the loving, secure relationship you want, as if it were already true. At the end of the week, reread your sentences and notice any change in your thoughts.

KEY AFFIRMATION

I am at peace with myself and with the whole world. I love everyone and everyone loves me.

MY OWN WORDS

CHAPTER

VI

Marriage

UNLESS MARRIAGE is built upon the rock of *oneness* it cannot stand; "Two souls with but a single thought, two hearts that beat as one."

The poet understood this, for unless man and wife are living the same thoughts (or living in the same thought world), they must inevitably drift apart.

Thought is a tremendous vibratory force and man is drawn to his thought creations.

For example: A man and woman married and were apparently happy. The man became successful and his tastes improved, but the wife still lived in a limited consciousness.

Whenever the man bought anything he went to the best shops and selected what he needed regardless of price.

Whenever the wife went out she haunted the Five and Ten Cent Stores.

He was living (in thought), on Fifth Avenue and her thought world was on Third Avenue.

Eventually the break and separation came.

We see this so often in the cases of rich and successful men who desert their faithful, hard-working wives later in life.

The wife must keep pace with her husband's taste and ambitions and live in his thought world, for *where* a man thinketh in his heart *there is he.*

There is for each person his "other half" or divine selection.

These two are one in their thought worlds.

These are the two "whom God has joined together and no man shall (or can) part asunder."

"The twain shall be made one," for in the superconscious mind of each is the same Divine Plan.

AFFIRMATION

I give thanks that the marriage made in
heaven is now made manifest upon earth.
"The twain shall be made one" now and for all eternity.

REFLECTION

Shinn believed that a marriage stands only when it is built on a shared inner life. She quotes a popular nineteenth-century stage line, "Two souls with but a single thought, two hearts that beat as one," and draws on Jesus' words about marriage: "they twain shall be one flesh" and "What therefore God hath joined together, let not man put asunder" (Matthew 19:5–6).

Her example is a couple who drifted apart as the husband's success and tastes grew while the wife kept a narrow outlook. In Shinn's picture, he lived on Fifth Avenue in his thoughts, while she remained on Third Avenue and in the Five and Ten Cent Stores. She bends Proverbs 23:7 ("as he thinketh in his heart, so is he") to say that we live where our thoughts live.

Some of this reflects the 1920s. Shinn places the burden of keeping pace on the wife, which many readers today will question. The deeper point travels well, though: partners need to keep growing together and share a "thought world." She also speaks of a "divine selection," the right partner meant for each person.

Today we might read this chapter as a call for both partners to grow, dream and talk together, and to hold their marriage in prayer.

PRACTICE

Set aside twenty quiet minutes with your partner, or by yourself if you are single. Each of you writes three hopes for the next five years. Share them and look for the places where they meet. If you are single, write a description of the shared life you hope for and the person you want to be within it. Close by saying the key affirmation aloud.

KEY AFFIRMATION

I give thanks that the marriage made in heaven is now made manifest upon earth.

MY OWN WORDS

CHAPTER

VII

Forgiveness

AFFIRMATIONS

I forgive everyone and everyone forgives me. The gates swing open for my good.

✦

I call on the law of forgiveness. I am free from mistakes and the consequences of mistakes. I am under grace and not under karmic law.

✦

Though my mistakes be as scarlet, I shall be washed whiter than snow.

✦

What didn't happen in the Kingdom never happened anywhere.

REFLECTION

This chapter contains no stories, only four short affirmations, but it carries one of Shinn's central themes. She believed that forgiveness opens the "gates" for

our good. Holding a grudge, in her view, blocks the flow of blessing, and so does holding on to our own guilt.

Her line "I am under grace and not under karmic law" echoes Paul's words in Romans 6:14, "ye are not under the law, but under grace." She means that we do not have to stay trapped in the consequences of every mistake we have made. "Though my mistakes be as scarlet, I shall be washed whiter than snow" draws on Isaiah 1:18 and Psalm 51:7. Her final line is bold: what did not happen in God's perfect kingdom "never happened anywhere." It is a way of saying that our failures do not define who we truly are.

Forgiveness does not mean pretending harm was acceptable, or staying in an unsafe situation. It means releasing the hold that the past has on your heart.

PRACTICE

1. Write the name of one person you are ready to begin forgiving. It may be yourself.
2. Under it, write: "I release you, and I release myself."
3. Say the key affirmation aloud slowly, three times.
4. If anger rises, don't fight it. Breathe, and say the words again.
5. Repeat each evening for a week.

KEY AFFIRMATION

I forgive everyone and everyone forgives me. The gates swing open for my good.

MY OWN WORDS

CHAPTER

VIII

Words of Wisdom

AFFIRMATIONS

"Faith without nerve is dead."

✦

There is never a slip 'twixt the right cup and the right lip.

✦

Never look or you'd never leap.

✦

God works in unexpected places, through unexpected people, at unexpected times, His wonders to perform.

✦

Power moves but is never moved.

✦

Loving your neighbor means not to limit your neighbor in word, thought or deed.

✦

"Never argue with a hunch."

✦

Christopher Columbus followed a hunch.

✦

The Kingdom of Heaven is the realm of perfect ideas.

✦

It is dark before the dawn but the
dawn never fails. Trust in the dawn.

✦

When in doubt play trumps, do the fearless thing.

✦

It is the fearless things that count.

✦

Never do today what intuition says to do tomorrow.

✦

It's a great life if you don't reason.

✦

Regard your neighbor as yourself.

✦

Never hinder another's hunch.

✦

Selfishness binds and blocks. Every loving and
unselfish thought has in it the germ of success.

✦

Be not weary of make-believing. When
you least expect it you shall reap.

✦

Faith is elastic. Stretch it to the end of your demonstration.

✦

Before you call you are answered,
for the supply precedes the demand.

✦

What you do for others you are doing for yourself.

✦

Every act committed while angry or
resentful brings unhappy reaction.

✦

Sorrow and disappointment follow in the wake of deceit and subterfuge. The way of the transgressor is hard. "No good thing will be withheld from him who walks uprightly."

✦

There is no power in evil. It is nothing;
therefore can only come to nothing.

✦

Fear and impatience demagnetize. Poise magnetizes.

✦

Drown the reasoning mind with your affirmation. Jehoshaphat clapped his cymbals so that he wouldn't hear himself think.

✦

All bondage is an illusion of the race consciousness. There is always a way out of every situation, under grace. Every man is free to do the will of God.

✦

Sure-ism is stronger than Optimism.

✦

"Divine ideas never conflict."

✦

It is dangerous to stop in the middle of a hunch.
Infinite Spirit is never too late.

✦

REFLECTION

This chapter is a collection of Shinn's sayings, many of them twists on familiar proverbs. "Look before you leap" becomes "Never look or you'd never leap." "There's many a slip 'twixt the cup and the lip" becomes a promise that the right cup reaches the right lip. "When in doubt play trumps" comes from card games and means: when unsure, take the bold, fearless step.

Several sayings deal with intuition, which Shinn calls a "hunch." She treats hunches as quiet divine guidance and warns against arguing with them, ignoring them or blocking someone else's. Christopher Columbus, in her telling, is the great example of someone who followed one.

Others draw on Scripture. "Faith without nerve is dead" plays on James 2:26 ("faith without works is dead"). "The way of the transgressor is hard" echoes Proverbs 13:15 ("the way of transgressors is hard"), and "No good thing will he withhold from them that walk uprightly" comes from Psalm 84:11. "Before you call you are answered" echoes Isaiah 65:24. Jehoshaphat's story of praise before a battle is told in 2 Chronicles 20; the cymbals are Shinn's own colorful touch.

Read slowly, this chapter works like a pocket book of encouragement. Pick one saying a day and let it keep you company.

PRACTICE

Read through the sayings and mark the three that make you smile or sit up. Write each one on a separate card. Carry one card per day for three days. Each evening, note one moment when the saying came to mind and how it changed what you did or felt.

KEY AFFIRMATION

It is dark before the dawn but the dawn never fails. Trust in the dawn.

MY OWN WORDS

CHAPTER

IX

Faith

HOPE LOOKS forward, *Faith knows it has already received and acts accordingly.*

In my classes I often emphasize the importance of digging ditches (or preparing for the thing asked for) which shows active faith and brings the demonstration to pass.

(See *The Game of Life and How to Play It*, page 17.)

A man in my class, whom I called "the life of the party," because he always tried to find a question I couldn't answer, but he never succeeded, asked: "Why is it then, a lot of women who prepare Hope Chests never get married?" I replied: "Because it is a Hope Chest and not a *Faith Chest.*"

The prospective bride also violates law in telling others about it. Her friends come in and sit on the Hope Chest and either doubt or hope she'll never succeed.

"Pray to thy Father which is in secret, and thy Father which seeth in secret shall reward thee openly."

The student should never talk of a demonstration until it "has jelled," or comes to pass on the external.

So a Hope Chest should become a Faith Chest and be kept from the public eye, and the word spoken for the Divine Selection of a husband,

under grace in a perfect way.

Those whom God hath joined together no thought can put asunder.

AFFIRMATIONS

Adverse appearances work for my good, for God utilizes every person and every situation to bring to me my heart's desire. "Hindrances are friendly" and obstacles spring boards! I now jump into my good!

✦

As I am one with the Undivided One, I am one with my undivided good.

✦

As the needle in the compass is true to the north, what is rightfully mine is true to me.

I am the North!

✦

"I am now linked by an invisible, unbreakable magnetic cord with all that belongs to me by Divine Right!

✦

Thy Kingdom is come, Thy will is done in me and my affairs.

✦

Every plan my Father in heaven has not planned is dissolved and obliterated and the Divine Design of my life now comes to pass.

✦

What God has given me can never be taken from me for His gifts are for all eternity.

✦

My faith is built upon a rock and my heart's desire now comes to pass, under grace in a miraculous way.

✦

I see my good in a golden glow of glory. I see my fields shining white with the harvest.

✦

God is my unfailing and immediate supply of all good.

✦

I am poised and powerful, my greatest expectations are realized in a miraculous way.

✦

I water my wilderness with faith and suddenly it blossoms as the rose.

✦

I now exercise my fearless faith in three ways—by thinking, speaking and acting. I am unmoved by appearances, therefore appearances move.

✦

I stand steadfast, immovable, giving thanks for my seeming impossible good to come to pass, for I know, with God, it is easy of accomplishment, and His time is now.

✦

God's plans for me are built upon a rock. What was mine in the beginning, is mine now and ever shall be mine.

✦

I know there is nothing to defeat God,
therefore, there is nothing to defeat me.

✦

I wait patiently on the Lord, I trust in Him, I fret not myself because of evil doers (for every man is a golden link in the chain of my good) and He now gives to me the desires of my heart! (See 37th Psalm.)

✦

I have now the fearless faith of the Christ within. At my approach barriers vanish and obstacles disappear.

✦

I am steadfast, immovable, for the fields are already white with the harvest. My fearless faith in God now brings the Divine Design of my life to pass.

✦

All fear is now banished in the name of Jesus Christ, for I know there is no power to hurt.
God is the one and only power.

✦

I am in perfect harmony with the working of the law, for I know that Infinite Intelligence knows nothing of obstacles, time or space. It knows only completion.

✦

God works in unexpected and magic
ways His wonders to perform.

✦

I now prepare for the fulfillment of my heart's desire. I show God I believe His promise will be kept.

✦

I now dig my ditches deep with faith and understanding and my heart's desire comes to pass in a surprising way.

✦

My ditches will be filled at the right time, bringing all that I have asked for, and more!

✦

I now "put to flight the army of the aliens" (negative thoughts). They feed on fear and starve on faith.

✦

God's ideas cannot be moved, therefore, what is mine by Divine Right will always be with me.

✦

I give thanks that I now receive the righteous desires of my heart.

Mountains are removed, valleys exalted and every crooked place made straight.

I am in the Kingdom of fulfillment.

✦

I have perfect confidence in God and God has perfect confidence in me.

✦

God's promises are built upon a rock. As I have asked I must receive.

✦

"Let me never wander from my heart's desire."

✦

I do not limit the Holy One of Isreal, in word, thought or deed.

With God all things are easy and possible now.

✦

I now stand aside and watch God work.
It interests me to see how quickly and easily
He brings the desires of my heart to pass.

✦

Before I called I was answered and I now
gather in my harvest in a remarkable way.

✦

He who watches over my heart's
desire "Neither slumbers nor sleeps."

✦

Seeming impossible doors now open, seeming impossible
channels are free, in the name of Jesus Christ.

✦

My good is a perfect and permanent idea in Divine
Mind, and must manifest for there is nothing to prevent.

✦

I cast every burden on the Christ within and I go free!
(See The Game of Life and How to Play It, pages 48-55.)

✦

REFLECTION

Shinn draws a sharp line between hope and faith. Hope looks forward; faith "knows it has already received and acts accordingly." Her favorite image for this is "digging ditches," taken from 2 Kings 3:16–17, where the prophet Elisha

tells the people to dig ditches in a dry valley because water is coming. In her teaching, preparing for your good is a way of showing you believe in it.

She tells a funny story from one of her classes. A student asked why so many women who fill a Hope Chest never marry. "Because it is a Hope Chest and not a *Faith* Chest," she replied. She adds that it is wise not to talk about your hopes too soon, quoting Matthew 6:6, "pray to thy Father which is in secret."

The affirmations here are among her richest. They echo Psalm 37 (which she cites by name), Psalm 121:4 ("shall neither slumber nor sleep"), Isaiah 40:4 ("every valley shall be exalted... and the crooked shall be made straight"), Hebrews 11:34 ("turned to flight the armies of the aliens"), Psalm 78:41 (limiting "the Holy One of Israel") and Psalm 55:22 (casting your burden on the Lord). Faith, for Shinn, means thinking, speaking and acting as if your prayer is already heard.

PRACTICE

Choose one hope you are holding. Ask yourself: "If I truly believed this was coming, what would I do to prepare?" Write down three possible "ditches" and dig one of them this week. Clear a shelf, update a résumé, take a class or set aside a small fund. Keep it quiet for now, and let your action speak your faith.

KEY AFFIRMATION

I now exercise my fearless faith in three ways—by thinking, speaking and acting.

MY OWN WORDS

CHAPTER

X

Loss

IF MAN loses anything it shows there is a belief of loss in his subconscious mind. As he erases this false belief, the article, or its equivalent will appear on the external.

For example: A woman lost a silver pencil in a theatre. She made every effort to find it but it was not returned.

She denied loss, taking the affirmation: "I deny loss, there is no loss in Divine Mind therefore I cannot lose that pencil. I will receive it or its equivalent."

Several weeks elapsed. One day she was with a friend who wore about her neck on a cord, a beautiful gold pencil, who turned to her and said: "Do you want this pencil? I paid fifty dollars for it at Tiffany's."

The woman was aghast, and replied (almost forgetting to thank her friend) "Oh! God aren't you wonderful! The silver pencil wasn't good enough for me!"

Man can only lose what doesn't belong to him by Divine Right, or isn't good enough for him.

AFFIRMATIONS

There is no loss in Divine Mind, therefore, I cannot lose anything that is rightfully mine. Infinite Intelligence is never too late! Infinite Intelligence knows the way of recovery.

✦

There is no loss in Divine Mind, therefore, I cannot lose anything which belongs to me. It will be restored or I receive its equivalent.

REFLECTION

Shinn teaches that losing something reflects a "belief of loss" in the subconscious mind, and that clearing that belief opens the way for the thing, or something equal to it, to return.

Her story is charming. A woman lost a silver pencil in a theater and could not find it. Instead of fretting, she affirmed that nothing that was rightfully hers could truly be lost. Weeks later a friend offered her a gold pencil that had cost fifty dollars (roughly $950 today) at Tiffany's. The delighted woman exclaimed that the silver pencil had not been good enough for her.

Shinn concludes that we can only lose what does not belong to us by divine right, or what is not good enough for us. That idea can be a real comfort when something slips away. It is best kept for everyday losses, like objects, chances and plans. Grief over people we love is a different and deeper matter, and it deserves time, care and support. Still, the habit of meeting small losses with calm trust instead of panic is a valuable one.

PRACTICE

Think of something you have lost recently, whether an object, an opportunity or a plan. Write it down, then write: "If this is mine, it will be restored or I will receive its equivalent." Do whatever is practical to recover it, then release the worry. Watch over the next weeks for surprising replacements, and write them down when they come.

KEY AFFIRMATION

There is no loss in Divine Mind, therefore, I cannot lose anything which belongs to me.

MY OWN WORDS

CHAPTER

XI

Debt

IF A man is in debt or people owe him money, it shows that a belief of debt is in his subconscious mind.

This belief must be neutralized in order to change conditions.

For example: A woman came to me saying a man had owed her a thousand dollars for years which she could not compel him to pay.

I said: "You must work on yourself, not the man," and gave her this statement: "I deny debt, there is no debt in Divine Mind, no man owes me anything, all is squared. I send that man love and forgiveness."

In a few weeks she received a letter from him saying he intended sending the money and in about a month came the thousand dollars.

If the student owes money, change the statement: "There is no debt in Divine Mind, therefore, I owe no man anything, all is *squared.*

All my obligations are now wiped out, under grace in a perfect way."

AFFIRMATIONS

I deny debt, there is no debt in Divine Mind, therefore, I owe no man anything. All obligations are now wiped out under grace in a miraculous way.

I deny debt, there is no debt in Divine Mind, no man owes me anything, all is squared. I send forth love and forgiveness.

REFLECTION

Shinn approached debt the way she approached most problems: start with the inner belief. In her view, owing money or being owed money points to a "belief of debt" in the mind, which needs to be dissolved.

She tells of a woman who had been owed a thousand dollars (roughly $19,000 today) for years. Shinn told her to work on herself, not the man, and gave her a statement denying debt and sending him love and forgiveness. Shinn reports that the money arrived within about a month.

It is important to read this chapter wisely. Shinn's affirmations are about releasing fear, blame and resentment around money, which can be a real gift when debt feels shameful or overwhelming. They are not a way to make legal obligations disappear. Paired with practical steps, they can help you face your finances with a clearer head: listing what you owe, talking honestly with creditors, making a realistic plan and getting reputable advice. The emotional shift Shinn describes, from dread and grudges to calm and goodwill, often makes those practical steps easier to take.

PRACTICE

1. Make a simple list of every debt you owe or are owed.
2. Read the list aloud, then say the key affirmation, sending goodwill to everyone named.
3. Choose one practical step this week: a payment plan, a polite reminder, a call to a nonprofit credit counselor or a budget session.
4. Repeat the affirmation each time you make a payment.

KEY AFFIRMATION

I deny debt, there is no debt in Divine Mind, no man owes me anything, all is squared. I send forth love and forgiveness.

MY OWN WORDS

CHAPTER

XII

Sales

A WOMAN who lived in a country town wished to sell her house and furniture. It was in the winter with snow so deep it was almost impossible for cars or wagons to reach her door.

As she had asked God to sell her furniture to the right person for the right price she was unmindful of appearances.

She polished the furniture, pushed it into the middle of the room and prepared to sell it.

She said: "I never looked out of the window at the blizzard, I simply trusted God's promises."

In miraculous ways people drove up and all the furniture was sold, and the house also, without paying any commission to an agent.

Faith never looks out of the window at the blizzard, it simply prepares for the blessing asked for.

AFFIRMATION

I give thanks that this article (or property) is now sold to the right person or persons for the right price, giving perfect satisfaction.

REFLECTION

This brief chapter tells a story about faith that does not look out the window. A woman in a country town wanted to sell her house and furniture in the middle of winter, with snow so deep that hardly anyone could reach her door. She had asked God to sell her things to the right person at the right price, so she ignored the weather. She polished the furniture, pushed it to the middle of the room and got ready to sell.

"I never looked out of the window at the blizzard," she said. Shinn reports that buyers came anyway, and that both the furniture and the house sold without an agent's commission.

The lesson is about preparation as an act of faith, the same "digging ditches" idea found in the Faith chapter. The affirmation she offers is notable for its fairness: it asks for the right buyer and the right price, "giving perfect satisfaction" to everyone. Whether you are selling a car, a home or your own handmade work, the chapter encourages you to prepare well and stop staring at the storm.

PRACTICE

If you have something to sell, prepare it as if the buyer is on the way. Clean it, photograph it well, write an honest description and set a fair price. Each time you check for responses, say the key affirmation instead of worrying. If nothing is for sale right now, apply the idea to a project you are waiting on.

KEY AFFIRMATION

I give thanks that this article (or property) is now sold to the right person or persons for the right price, giving perfect satisfaction.

MY OWN WORDS

CHAPTER

XIII

Interviews

AFFIRMATIONS

There is no competition on the Spiritual plane. What is mine is given me, under grace.

I am identified in love with the Spirit of this person (or persons). God protects my interests and the Divine Idea now comes out of this situation.

REFLECTION

Two short affirmations make up this chapter, written for the anxious moments before a meeting that matters. The first takes the pressure off: on the spiritual level there is no competition, and what is truly yours will come to you. The second asks you to feel connected "in love" with the person interviewing you, trusting that God protects your interests and that the best outcome will emerge. Together they shift your stance from fear and rivalry to calm goodwill, which is also a helpful frame of mind for any interview.

PRACTICE

On the morning of an interview, prepare thoroughly: research, practice answers, plan your outfit. Then sit quietly for two minutes. Picture the person you will meet and silently wish them well. Say both affirmations from this chapter aloud. Walk in remembering that you are there to meet someone, not to fight anyone.

KEY AFFIRMATION

There is no competition on the Spiritual plane. What is mine is given me, under grace.

MY OWN WORDS

CHAPTER

XIV

Guidance

ALWAYS ON man's pathway is his message or his lead.

For example: A woman was much troubled over an unhappy situation. She thought to herself, "Will it ever clear up?"

Her maid was standing near and commenced to tell her of her experiences. The woman was too worried to be interested but listened patiently. The maid was saying: "I worked in a hotel once where there was a very amusing gardener, he always said such funny things. It had been raining for three days and I said to him: 'Do you think it will ever clear up?' And he replied, 'My God, doesn't it always clear up?'"

The woman was amazed! It was the answer to her thoughts. She said reverently, "Yes, with my God it always clears up!" Soon after, her problem did clear up in an unexpected way.

AFFIRMATIONS

Infinite Spirit, give me wisdom to
make the most of my opportunities.
Never let me miss a trick.

I am always under direct inspiration. I know just what to do and give instant obedience to my intuitive leads.

✦

My angel of destiny goes before me, keeping me in the Way.

✦

All power is given unto me to be meek and lowly of heart. I am willing to come last, therefore, I come first!

✦

I now place my personal will upon the altar. Your will, not my will; Your way not my way; Your time not my time—and in the twinkling of an eye it is done!

✦

There are no mysteries in the Kingdom. Whatever I should know will now be revealed to me, under grace.

✦

I am a perfect non-resistant instrument for God to work through, and His perfect plan for me now comes to pass in a magic way.

✦

REFLECTION

Shinn believed that answers are always on our path, often in unexpected places. Her story is a lovely one. A worried woman wondered whether her troubles would ever clear up. Her maid, chatting nearby, told a story about a hotel gardener who, after three days of rain, replied: "My God, doesn't it always clear up?" The woman took it as a direct answer to her thoughts, and soon afterward, Shinn reports, her problem resolved in an unexpected way.

The affirmations ask for wisdom, intuition and humility. "My angel of destiny goes before me, keeping me in the Way" echoes Exodus 23:20, "I send

an Angel before thee, to keep thee in the way." Being "meek and lowly of heart" comes from Jesus in Matthew 11:29, and the idea that the last shall be first comes from Matthew 20:16. "Your will, not my will" recalls Jesus' prayer in Luke 22:42, and "in the twinkling of an eye" comes from 1 Corinthians 15:52.

For readers today, this chapter is an invitation to listen more closely: to conversations, chance remarks and quiet inner nudges.

PRACTICE

Write down a question you need guidance on. Say: "Infinite Spirit, give me wisdom," and then let it go. For the next three days, keep a small notebook. Jot down any remark, sign, song lyric or inner nudge that seems to speak to your question. At the end, read it over and choose one wise step.

KEY AFFIRMATION

I am always under direct inspiration. I know just what to do and give instant obedience to my intuitive leads.

MY OWN WORDS

CHAPTER

XV

Protection

AFFIRMATIONS

I am surrounded by the White Light of the Christ,
through which nothing negative can penetrate.

I walk in the Light of the Christ and my
fear giants dwindle into nothingness.
There is nothing to oppose my good.

REFLECTION

This chapter offers two brief affirmations for times when you feel exposed, anxious or surrounded by negativity. The first pictures you wrapped in the white light of Christ, where nothing negative can reach you. The second sees your "fear giants" shrinking to nothing as you walk in that light, a phrase that brings to mind the giants the Israelite spies feared in the promised land (Numbers 13:33). Many readers find that a calm image like this helps settle the nervous system before a hard day. It works best alongside sensible, practical safety.

PRACTICE

Before leaving home, close your eyes for one minute. Picture a soft white light surrounding you completely. Name one fear you are carrying today and imagine it growing smaller and smaller in that light. Say the key affirmation once aloud. Then go about your day, taking the usual sensible precautions.

KEY AFFIRMATION

I walk in the Light of the Christ and my fear giants dwindle into nothingness.

MY OWN WORDS

CHAPTER

XVI

Memory

AFFIRMATION

There is no loss of memory in Divine Mind,
therefore, I recollect everything I should
remember and I forget all that is not for my good.

REFLECTION

This is the shortest chapter in the book: a single affirmation. Shinn applies her usual principle that there is no loss in Divine Mind to memory itself. The statement is wonderfully balanced. It asks not only to remember everything you should, but also to forget whatever is not for your good. Many of us need both: help recalling names, tasks and facts, and help letting go of old hurts that replay in our minds. If you are worried about real changes in your memory, talk with a doctor, and let this affirmation be a calm companion along the way.

PRACTICE

When you can't recall something, stop straining. Take a slow breath, say the affirmation, and move on to something else. Often the memory returns on its

own. At night, use the second half of the statement to release one painful memory that keeps replaying.

KEY AFFIRMATION

There is no loss of memory in Divine Mind,
therefore, I recollect everything I should
remember and I forget all that is not for my good.

MY OWN WORDS

CHAPTER

XVII

Divine Design

(See also *The Game of Life and How to Play It.*)

There is a Divine Design for each man!

Just as the perfect picture of the oak is in the acorn, the divine pattern of his life is in the superconscious mind of man.

In the Divine Design there is no limitation, only health, wealth, love and perfect self-expression.

So on man's pathway there is always a Divine Selection. Each day he must live according to the Divine Plan or have unhappy reactions.

For example: A woman moved into a new apartment which she had almost furnished, when the thought came to her: "On that side of the room should stand a Chinese cabinet!

Not long after, she was walking by an antique shop. She glanced in and there stood a magnificent Chinese cabinet about eight feet high, elaborately carved.

She entered and asked the price. The salesman said it was worth a thousand dollars but the woman who owned it was willing to take less. The man added: "What will you offer for it?" The woman paused and the price "Two hundred dollars" came into her mind, so she answered: "Two hundred dollars." The man said he would let her know if the offer were satisfactory.

She did not want to cheat anyone or get anything which was not rightfully hers, so going home she said repeatedly: "*If it's mine I can't lose it and if it isn't mine, I don't want it.*" It was a snowy day and she said she emphasized her words by kicking the snow from right to left, clearing a pathway to her apartment.

Several days elapsed when she was notified that the woman was willing to sell the cabinet for two hundred dollars.

There is a supply for every demand, from Chinese cabinets to millions of dollars.

"Before ye call I shall answer," but, unless it is the Divinely Selected cabinet or millions they would never bring happiness.

"Except the Lord build the house, they labor in vain that build it." (Psalm 127-1.)

AFFIRMATIONS

I let go of everything not divinely designed for me,
and the perfect plan of my life now comes to pass.

✦

What is mine by Divine Right can never be taken from me.
God's perfect plan for me is built upon a rock.

✦

I follow the magic path of intuition and find
myself in my Promised Land, under grace.

✦

My mind, body and affairs are now molded
according to the Divine pattern within.

✦

"God is the only power and that power is within me. There is
only one plan, God's plan, and that plan now comes to pass."

✦

"I give thanks that I now bring forth from the Universal Substance everything that satisfies all the righteous desires of my heart."

✦

The divine Design of my life now comes to pass. I now fill the place that I can fill and no one else can fill. I now do the things which I can do and no one else can do.

✦

I am fully equipped for the Divine Plan of my life; I am more than equal to the situation.

✦

All doors now open for happy surprises and the Divine Plan of my life is speeded up under grace.

✦

REFLECTION

Divine Design is one of Shinn's most beloved ideas. Just as the whole oak tree is present in the acorn, she says, a perfect pattern for each person's life exists in the "superconscious mind." That pattern holds health, abundance, love and "perfect self-expression," and it unfolds day by day as we follow our intuition.

Her story is about a woman furnishing a new apartment who suddenly pictured a Chinese cabinet in one corner. Soon she found a magnificent carved cabinet in an antique shop, said to be worth a thousand dollars (roughly $19,000 today). A price of two hundred dollars (about $3,800 today) came to her mind, so she offered it. Walking home through the snow, she kept repeating, "If it's mine I can't lose it and if it isn't mine, I don't want it." Days later, the owner accepted her offer.

Shinn quotes Psalm 127:1, "Except the LORD build the house, they labour in vain that build it," and echoes Isaiah 65:24, "before they call, I will answer."

The point is not to grab anything you want. Even millions, she says, bring no happiness unless they belong to the plan meant for you. This idea can be freeing: you don't have to chase someone else's path.

PRACTICE

1. Sit quietly and ask: "What is the acorn in me? What am I uniquely made to do?"
2. Write freely for ten minutes without editing.
3. Underline anything that makes you feel lighter or more alive.
4. Choose one underlined item and take a small step toward it this week.
5. Use the key affirmation when you feel pulled toward someone else's path.

KEY AFFIRMATION

I let go of everything not divinely designed for me,
and the perfect plan of my life now comes to pass.

MY OWN WORDS

CHAPTER

XVIII

Health

WHEN MAN is harmonious and happy he is healthy! All sickness comes from sin or violation of Spiritual Law.

Jesus Christ said: "Be thou healed, your sins are forgiven."

Resentment, ill-will, hate, fear, etc., etc., tear down the cells of the body and poison the blood.

(See *The Game of Life and How to Play It*, page 23.)

Accidents, old age and death itself, come from holding wrong mental pictures.

When man sees himself as God sees him, he will become a radiant being, timeless, birthless and deathless, for "God made man in His likeness and in His image."

AFFIRMATIONS

I deny fatigue, for there is nothing to tire me.
I live in the Kingdom of eternal joy and absorbing interests.
My body is "the body electric," timeless
and tireless, birthless and deathless.

✦

Time and space are obliterated!

I live in the wonderful now, birthless and deathless!
I am one with The One!

✦

Thou in me art:
Eternal joy.
Eternal youth.
Eternal wealth.
Eternal health.
Eternal love.
Eternal life.

✦

I am a Spiritual Being—my body is
perfect, made in His likeness and image.
The Light of the Christ now streams through
every cell. I give thanks for my radiant health.

✦

REFLECTION

In this chapter Shinn makes some of her strongest claims. She writes that "all sickness comes from sin or violation of Spiritual Law," that fear and resentment damage the body, and even that old age and death come from wrong mental pictures. She recalls Jesus' healings, where forgiveness and healing go together (as with the paralyzed man in Mark 2:5–11), and quotes Genesis 1:27 on being made in God's image. "The body electric" is borrowed from the poet Walt Whitman.

These views reflect New Thought teaching of the 1920s and should be read as her beliefs, not as medical fact. Illness is not a sign of personal failure or sin, and no one should feel blamed for being sick. At the same time, most of us

know that stress, fear and bitterness affect how we feel, and that hope and peace can support well-being.

Please treat these affirmations as a spiritual and emotional practice that goes alongside medical care, never in place of it. If you have symptoms or a diagnosis, see a doctor and follow their advice. Many readers find that affirmations help them feel calmer and more hopeful during treatment.

PRACTICE

Each morning this week, place a hand on your heart and say the key affirmation slowly. Then name one thing you will do today to care for your body: drink water, take a walk, take your medication, rest, or book that overdue checkup. Affirmations work best as a companion to good medical care, never a replacement for it.

KEY AFFIRMATION

I live in the Kingdom of eternal joy and absorbing interests.

MY OWN WORDS

CHAPTER

XIX

Eyes

(*Imperfect vision. Correspondences—Fear, suspicion, seeing obstacles. Watching for unhappy events to come to pass—living in the past or future—not living in the NOW.*)

AFFIRMATIONS

The Light of the Christ now floods my eyeballs. I have the crystal clear vision of the Spirit. I see clearly and distinctly there are no obstacles on my pathway. I see clearly the fulfillment of my heart's desire.

✦

I have the X-ray eye of the Spirit. I see through apparent obstacles. I see clearly the miracle come to pass.

✦

I have the crystal clear vision of the Spirit, I see clearly the open road. There are no obstacles on my pathway. I now see miracles and wonders come to pass.

✦

I give thanks for my perfect sight. I see God in every face, I see good in every situation.

✦

I have the crystal clear vision of the Spirit. I look up and down and all around, for my good comes from North, South, East and West.

✦

My eyes are God's eyes, perfect and flawless. The Light of the Christ floods my eyeballs and streams on my pathway. I see clearly there are no lions on my way, only angels and endless blessings.

✦

REFLECTION

Shinn links poor eyesight with certain mental habits: fear, suspicion, always looking for obstacles, and living in the past or future instead of the present. Her affirmations are as much about how we see life as about physical sight: seeing God in every face, good in every situation, and an open road ahead. Read them as a spiritual practice for changing your outlook. They are not a treatment for eye conditions. Keep up regular eye exams, and see an eye doctor promptly about any change in your vision.

PRACTICE

Today, practice "seeing clearly" in Shinn's spiritual sense. Each time you notice yourself expecting the worst, look around and name one good thing you can actually see. At night, say the key affirmation. And if your eyes need attention, book an eye exam this week. The affirmation is a companion to professional care, not a substitute.

KEY AFFIRMATION

I see God in every face, I see good in every situation.

MY OWN WORDS

CHAPTER

XX

Anaemia

(*Correspondence—Unfed desires—lack of happiness.*)

AFFIRMATION

I am nourished by the Spirit within. Every cell in my body is filled with light. I give thanks for radiant health and endless happiness. (This statement may be used in the healing of any disease.)

REFLECTION

Shinn connects anaemia (spelled the British way here) with "unfed desires" and a lack of happiness. Her single affirmation speaks of being nourished by the Spirit and filled with light, and she notes it may be used for any illness. Many readers find this a beautiful prayer for times of weariness or low spirits. It should never replace medical care. Anemia has real physical causes, such as low iron or other conditions, that a doctor can test for and treat. Use the affirmation as emotional and spiritual support alongside that care.

PRACTICE

1. Ask yourself: "What desire in me feels unfed?" Write it down.
2. Plan one small way to nourish it this week.
3. Say the key affirmation with each meal as a moment of gratitude.
4. If you feel persistently tired, weak or short of breath, see a doctor. Simple blood tests can find the cause.

KEY AFFIRMATION

I am nourished by the Spirit within.

MY OWN WORDS

CHAPTER

XXI

Ears

(*Deafness—Correspondence—Strong personal will, stubbornness and a desire not to hear certain things.*)

AFFIRMATION

My ears are the ears of Spirit. The Light of
the Christ now streams through my ears
dissolving all hardness or malformation.
I hear clearly the voice of intuition and give instant obedience.
I hear clearly glad tidings of great joy.

REFLECTION

Shinn associates hearing problems with stubbornness, a strong personal will and not wanting to hear certain things. Her affirmation turns this into a prayer for open listening: hearing the voice of intuition clearly, and hearing "glad tidings of great joy," the angel's words to the shepherds in Luke 2:10. You can use it as a spiritual practice of becoming more open and receptive. It is not a

treatment for hearing loss. Please see a doctor or hearing specialist about any change in your hearing, and use the affirmation alongside their care.

PRACTICE

For one day, practice listening fully. In each conversation, let the other person finish before you respond. In the evening, sit in silence for five minutes and listen inwardly, then say the key affirmation. If you have noticed changes in your hearing, make an appointment for a hearing test. Prayer and medical care can go together.

KEY AFFIRMATION

I hear clearly the voice of intuition
and give instant obedience.

MY OWN WORDS

CHAPTER

XXII

Rheumatism

(*Correspondence—Fault finding, criticism, etc.*)

AFFIRMATION

The Light of the Christ now floods my
consciousness dissolving all acid thoughts.
I love everyone and everyone loves me.
I give thanks for my radiant health and happiness.

REFLECTION

Shinn links rheumatism, a word once used for many kinds of joint and muscle pain, with faultfinding and criticism. Her affirmation asks for light to dissolve "acid thoughts" and affirms love for everyone. Letting go of a critical spirit is a worthy goal in itself, and it may bring more ease and peace. But joint pain has physical causes that need proper diagnosis and treatment. Treat this affirmation as a spiritual and emotional practice alongside, never instead of, the care of a doctor.

PRACTICE

For three days, keep a tally of critical thoughts about yourself and others. Don't judge the count, just notice it. Each time, gently replace the thought with "I love everyone and everyone loves me." If you live with joint pain, keep following your doctor's advice, or make an appointment if you haven't yet.

KEY AFFIRMATION

The Light of the Christ now floods my consciousness dissolving all acid thoughts.

MY OWN WORDS

CHAPTER

XXIII

False Growths

(*Correspondence—Jealousy, hatred, resentment, fear, etc., etc.*)

AFFIRMATION

Every plant my Father in Heaven has not planted shall be rooted up. All false ideas in my consciousness are now obliterated. The Light of the Christ streams through every cell and I give thanks for my radiant health and happiness now and forevermore.

REFLECTION

Shinn ties abnormal growths in the body to jealousy, hatred, resentment and fear. Her affirmation draws on Matthew 15:13, "Every plant, which my heavenly Father hath not planted, shall be rooted up," and asks that every false idea be cleared from the mind. Releasing jealousy and resentment is spiritually healthy, but it is essential to be clear: any lump or growth needs prompt medical attention. Please see a doctor without delay. Use this prayer only as a spiritual and emotional practice alongside your treatment, never in place of it.

PRACTICE

Write down one jealous or resentful thought you would like to "uproot." Picture pulling it out like a weed and replacing it with a flower. Say the key affirmation as you do. Most important: if you have noticed any lump, swelling or unusual change in your body, call your doctor today. Your spiritual practice and your medical care belong together.

KEY AFFIRMATION

All false ideas in my consciousness are now obliterated.

MY OWN WORDS

CHAPTER

XXIV

Heart Disease

(*Correspondence—Fear, Anger, etc.*)

AFFIRMATION

My heart is a perfect idea in Divine Mind and
is now in its right place, doing its right work.
It is a happy heart, a fearless heart and a loving heart.
The Light of the Christ streams through every
cell and I give thanks for my radiant health.

REFLECTION

Shinn connects heart trouble with fear and anger. Her affirmation describes the heart as a perfect idea in God's mind, "a happy heart, a fearless heart and a loving heart." There is real wisdom in tending the emotional heart, and it is well known that stress and anger affect how we feel. But heart disease is serious and needs medical care. Use this affirmation as a spiritual and emotional practice alongside your doctor's treatment, never instead of it. If you ever have chest pain or shortness of breath, call emergency services right away.

PRACTICE

Twice a day, sit quietly with one hand over your heart. Breathe slowly for one minute, then say the key affirmation. Let it soften fear and anger. Keep your medical appointments, take any prescribed medication and follow your doctor's advice. This affirmation is meant to support that care, not replace it.

KEY AFFIRMATION

It is a happy heart, a fearless heart and a loving heart.

MY OWN WORDS

CHAPTER

XXV

Animals

(*Dog: for example*)

AFFIRMATIONS

I deny any appearance of disorder. This dog is a perfect idea in Divine Mind and now expresses God's perfect Idea of a perfect dog.

Infinite Intelligence illumines and directs this animal. It is a perfect idea in Divine Mind and is always in its right place.

REFLECTION

Shinn's love of animals shows in this little chapter of prayers, using a dog as her example. Her affirmations see the animal as a perfect idea in God's mind, guided by divine intelligence and always "in its right place." Many pet owners find comfort in speaking blessings over a sick, anxious or wandering animal. Pair this with good practical care. If your pet is unwell, take it to a veterinarian. If it is lost, search, call shelters and put up notices while you pray.

PRACTICE

Sit quietly with your pet, or picture an animal you love. Rest your hand on it, if you can, and slowly say the key affirmation. Notice any calm that settles over both of you. Then take one practical step for its well-being today, such as a walk, a vet appointment or a fresh look at its food and water.

KEY AFFIRMATION

Infinite Intelligence illumines and directs this animal.

MY OWN WORDS

CHAPTER

XXVI

Elements

MAN IS made in God's likeness and image (Imagination) and is given power and dominion over all created things.

He has power to "rebuke the winds and the waves," check floods or bring rain when it is needed.

There is a tribe of American Indians who live in the desert country and depend on the power of prayer only, to bring rain to water their crops.

They have a rain dance, which is a form of prayer, but no chief is allowed to take part who has any fear.

They give exhibitions of courage before they are admitted to the ceremonies.

A woman, who was an eye-witness, told me that out of a blue sky came a *deluge of rain; the sun still shining.*

Fire

AFFIRMATION

Fire is man's friend and is always in its right place doing its right work.

Drought

AFFIRMATION

There is no drought in Divine Mind. I give thanks for the right amount of rain to nourish these crops or garden. I see clearly this gentle downpour and the manifestation is now.

Storms

AFFIRMATION

The Christ within now rebukes the winds and the waves and there comes a great calm. I see clearly peace established on land and sea.

REFLECTION

Shinn believed that human beings, made in God's image (Genesis 1:26–27) and given "dominion" over creation, can influence even the weather through faith. She recalls Jesus calming the storm (Mark 4:39), when he "rebuked the wind" and "there was a great calm."

She tells of a Native American desert people who pray for rain through a ceremonial dance, and she says only those who show no fear may take part. A woman who saw it told her rain poured from a blue sky while the sun still shone. Shinn's description is brief and comes secondhand, and it reflects the outsider's view of her time.

Her short affirmations cover fire, drought and storms. Whatever your view of praying about the weather, they can steady the mind when nature feels frightening. In a storm or emergency, follow official safety advice first. Then let prayer bring calm.

PRACTICE

The next time a storm, heat wave or other weather worry unsettles you, take sensible precautions first. Then sit quietly and say: "The Christ within now rebukes the winds and the waves and there comes a great calm." Notice your breathing slow. Apply the same words to any "storm" in your inner life.

KEY AFFIRMATION

The Christ within now rebukes the winds
and the waves and there comes a great calm.

MY OWN WORDS

CHAPTER

XXVII

Journey

AFFIRMATION

I give thanks for the Divinely planned journey under Divinely planned conditions with the Divinely planned supply.

REFLECTION

A single affirmation makes up this chapter. It asks for three things on any trip: the right journey, the right conditions and the right supply. It is a lovely prayer for travel of any kind, whether a commute, a vacation, a move to a new city or a big life transition. Saying it before setting out can turn nervousness into trust. Pair it with good planning, sensible budgeting and the usual travel precautions.

PRACTICE

Before your next trip, large or small, write down your plans and budget. Then sit for a moment, say the key affirmation, and picture yourself arriving safely and happily. Keep a copy of the affirmation in your wallet or phone and repeat it whenever delays or worries come up along the way.

KEY AFFIRMATION

I give thanks for the Divinely planned journey under Divinely planned conditions with the Divinely planned supply.

MY OWN WORDS

CHAPTER

XXVIII

Miscellaneous

THE THING you dislike or hate will surely come upon you, for when man hates, he makes a vivid picture in the subconscious mind and it objectifies.

The only way to erase these pictures is through non-resistance.

(See *The Game of Life and How to Play It*, pages 30-38.)

For example: A woman was interested in a man who told her repeatedly of his charming women cousins.

She was jealous and resentful and he passed out of her life.

Later on she met another man to whom she was much attracted. In the course of their conversation he mentioned some women cousins he was very fond of.

She resented it, then laughed, for here were her old friends "the cousins" back again.

This time she tried non-resistance. She blessed all the cousins in the Universe and sent them good-will, for she knew if she didn't, every man she met would be stocked up with women relations.

It was successful for she never heard cousins mentioned again.

This is the reason so many people have unhappy experiences repeated in their lives.

I knew a woman who bragged of her troubles. She would go about saying to people; "I know what trouble is!" and then wait for their words of sympathy.

Of course, the more she mentioned her troubles, the more she had, for by her words she "was condemned."

She should have used her words to neutralize her troubles instead of to multiply them.

For example—had she said repeatedly: "I cast every burden upon the Christ within and I go free," and not voiced her sorrows, they would have faded from her life, for "*by your words you are justified.*"

✦

"I will give to thee the land that thou *seest.*"

Man is ever reaping on the external what he has sown in his thought world.

For example: A woman needed money and was walking along the street making the affirmation that God was her immediate supply.

She looked down and at her feet was a two dollar bill, which she picked up.

A man standing near (a watchman in a building), said to her: "Lady, did you pick up some money? I thought it was a piece of chewing-gum paper. A lot of people walked over it, but *when you came it opened up like a leaf.*"

The others, thinking lack, had passed over it, but at her words of faith it unfurled.

So with the opportunities in life—one man sees, another passes by.

✦

"Faith without works (or action) is dead."

The student, in order to bring into manifestation the answer to his prayer must show *active faith.*

For example: A woman came to me asking me to speak the word for the renting of a room.

I gave her the statement: "I give thanks that the room is now rented to the right and perfect man for the right price, giving perfect satisfaction."

Several weeks elapsed but the room had not been rented.

I asked: "Have you shown active faith? Have you followed every hunch in regard to the room?" She replied: "I had a hunch to get a lamp for the room, but I decided I couldn't afford it." I said: "You'll never rent the room until you get the lamp, for in buying the lamp you are *acting your faith,* impressing the subconscious mind with *certainty.*"

I asked: "What is the price of the lamp?" She answered: "Four dollars." I exclaimed: "Four dollars standing between you and the perfect man!"

She became so enthusiastic, she bought *two* lamps.

About a week elapsed and in walked the perfect man. He did not smoke and paid the rent in advance and fulfilled her ideal in every way.

Unless you become as a little child and dig your ditches you shall in no wise enter the Kingdom of manifestation.

(See *The Game of Life and How to Play It*, page 17.)

✦

"Without the vision my people perish." Unless man has some objective, some Promised Land to look forward to, he begins to perish.

We see it so often in small country towns, in the men who sit around a stove all winter, who "Ain't got no ambition."

Within each one is an undiscovered country, a gold mine.

I knew a man in a country town called "Magnolia Charlie," because he always found the first magnolia in the spring.

He was a shoemaker, but every afternoon left his work to go to the station to meet the four-fifteen train, from a distant city.

They were the only romances in his life, the first magnolia and the four-fifteen train.

He felt vaguely the call of the vision in the superconscious mind.

No doubt, the Divine Design for him included travel and perhaps he was to become a genius in the plant world.

Through the spoken word the Divine Design may be released and each one fulfill his destiny.

"I now see clearly the perfect plan of my life. Divine enthusiasm fires me and I now fulfill my destiny."

✦

The Spiritual attitude towards money is to know that God *is man's supply,* and that he draws it from the abundance of the spheres, through his faith and spoken word.

When man realizes this he loses all greed for money, and is fearless in letting it go out.

With his magic purse of the Spirit, his supply is *endless* and *immediate,* and he knows also that *giving* precedes *receiving.*

For example: "A woman came to me asking me to speak the word for five hundred dollars by the first of August. (It was then about the first of July.)

I knew her very well, and said: "The trouble with you is you don't *give* enough. You must open your channels of supply by *giving.*"

She had accepted an invitation to visit a friend and did not want to go on account of the formality.

She said: "Please treat me to be polite for three weeks, and I want to get away as soon as possible, and be sure to speak the word for the five hundred dollars."

She went to the friend's house, was unhappy and restless and tried continually to leave, but was always persuaded to stay longer.

She remembered my advice, however, and gave the people about her presents. Whenever possible she made a little gift.

It was nearing the first of August and no signs of the five hundred dollars, and no way of escape from the visit.

The last day of July she said: "Oh God! maybe I haven't given enough!" So she tipped all the servants more than she had intended.

The first of August, her hostess said to her: "My dear, I want to make *you* a gift," and she handed her a check for five hundred dollars!

God works in unexpected ways his wonders to perform.

AFFIRMATIONS

God is incapable of separation or division; therefore, my good is incapable of separation or division. I am one with my undivided good.

✦

All that is mine by Divine Right is now released and reaches me in a perfect way under Grace.

✦

God's work is finished now and must manifest.

✦

I serve only faith and my unlimited abundance is made manifest.

✦

I am undisturbed by appearances. I trust in God—and He now brings to me the desires of my heart.

✦

My good now overtakes me in a surprising way.

✦

The Divine Plan of my life cannot be tampered with. It is incorruptible and indestructible. It awaits only my recognition.

✦

There is no there—there is only here.

✦

Reveal to me the way, let me see clearly the blessing which Thou hast given me.

✦

Let Thy blessed will be done in me this day.

✦

Hunches are my hounds of Heaven
—they lead me in the perfect way.

✦

All things I seek are now seeking me.

✦

Divine Activity is now operating in my mind,
body and affairs, whether I see it or not.

✦

Since I am one with the Only Presence,
I am one with my heart's desire.

✦

I now have the single eye of the Spirit and see only completion.

✦

I am a perfect idea in Divine Mind and I am always in my right place doing my right work at the right time for the right pay.

✦

The Columbus in you will see you through.

✦

I am an irresistible magnet for checks, bills and currency
—for everything that belongs to me by Divine Right.

✦

Thou in me art completion. As I have asked I must receive.

✦

The law of God is the law of increase and I give thanks for increase under grace in perfect ways.

✦

I dwell in a sea of abundance. I see clearly my inexhaustible supply. I see clearly just what to do.

✦

My "World of the Wondrous" now swings into manifestation and I enter my Promised Land under grace!

✦

Great peace have I who love thy law of nonresistance and nothing shall offend me.

✦

Thou in me art Inspiration, Revelation and Illumination.

✦

Nothing is too good to be true
Nothing is too wonderful to happen
Nothing is too good to last

✦

REFLECTION

This is one of the richest chapters. Shinn warns that what we hate or fear tends to come back to us, because resentment paints a vivid picture in the mind. Her cure is "non-resistance." She tells of a woman irritated by a suitor's endless talk of his charming female cousins. When a second man did the same, she laughed, blessed "all the cousins in the Universe," and never heard of them again.

Other stories show active faith. A woman praying for a lodger had a hunch to buy a four-dollar lamp (roughly $75 today) but felt she couldn't afford it. Shinn told her to buy it, and soon the ideal tenant appeared. Another woman,

asking for five hundred dollars (about $9,500 today), began giving small gifts and generous tips, and Shinn reports her hostess handed her a check for exactly that amount.

Scripture runs throughout: "I will give to thee the land that thou seest" (Genesis 13:15), "faith without works is dead" (James 2:26), becoming "as little children" (Matthew 18:3), and "where there is no vision, the people perish" (Proverbs 29:18). "Great peace have they which love thy law" is Psalm 119:165.

The chapter's gentle "Magnolia Charlie," a shoemaker who loved the first magnolia and the afternoon train, reminds us that everyone carries a dream.

PRACTICE

1. Notice one complaint you keep repeating to others. For one week, stop voicing it.
2. Replace it with: "I cast every burden upon the Christ within and I go free."
3. Identify one small act of "active faith," like your own "lamp," and do it.
4. Give one unexpected small gift or kindness.
5. Write down what changes.

KEY AFFIRMATION

All things I seek are now seeking me.

MY OWN WORDS

CHAPTER

XXIX

Conclusion

CHOOSE THE affirmation which appeals to you the most and *wave it over the situation which confronts you.*

It is your *magic wand,* for your *word* is God in *action.*

"It shall not return unto me void but shall accomplish that whereunto it is sent." (Isaiah 55-11.)

"But I say, have they not heard? Yes, verily, their sound went into all the earth and *their words unto the end of the world.*" (Romans 10-18.)

REFLECTION

Shinn ends her book in just a few lines. Choose the affirmation that speaks to you most, she says, and "wave it over the situation" in front of you, because your word is "God in action." She closes with two Bible verses. The first is Isaiah 55:11, where God says his word "shall not return unto me void, but it shall accomplish that which I please." The second is Romans 10:18, "their words unto the ends of the world." (She quotes both from memory, with small differences from the King James wording.)

Her parting advice is wonderfully practical: you don't need to use every affirmation in the book. One phrase that rings true for you, spoken faithfully,

is enough to begin. Many readers find that a single sentence becomes a lifelong companion.

PRACTICE

Look back through the book and choose the one affirmation that moved you most. Write it on a card and place it where you will see it every morning. Commit to saying it aloud daily for the next 30 days, and pair it with one practical action that supports it. Then turn to the 30-Day Practice that follows.

KEY AFFIRMATION

It shall not return unto me void but shall accomplish that whereunto it is sent.

MY OWN WORDS

The 30-Day Practice

Shinn ends her book with a simple instruction: choose an affirmation and use it. This 30-day practice is one way to do that. Each day offers a single statement, quoted exactly from her text, along with a short prompt or task to help you live it out.

The month follows an arc. Week one lays the foundations: the power of your words, the nature of faith, and loosening the grip of fear. Week two turns to relationships and forgiveness, which Shinn treated as central to everything else. Week three addresses practical life: work, money and guidance. Week four focuses on peace of mind, gratitude and her idea of a Divine Design for each life. The final two days invite you to look back and choose the words you will carry forward.

A few suggestions:

- Set aside five to ten quiet minutes each morning. Read the day's affirmation aloud at least three times.
- Keep a notebook for the prompts. Your notes will be part of the review on Day 29.
- Return to the affirmation during the day, especially when you feel anxious or stuck.
- Pair the words with action. Shinn's faith was always active.
- If you miss a day, simply pick up where you left off. This is a practice, not a test.

These affirmations are a spiritual and emotional practice. They are not a substitute for medical, financial or professional advice.

DAY

1

The Power of Your Word

Give thanks for the sun!

YOUR WORD IS YOUR WAND

Today, notice how you talk about your life, both aloud and in your head. Write down three phrases you use often. For each one that drags you down, write a brighter version you can say instead.

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

DAY

2

Laying Down Burdens

I cast every burden on the Christ within and I go free!

FAITH

Make a list of everything weighing on you right now. Read the list once, then say the affirmation and imagine handing the whole list over. Notice which burden feels lightest afterward.

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

DAY

3

Faith That Knows

I have perfect confidence in God and
God has perfect confidence in me.

FAITH

Shinn said hope looks forward, while faith knows. Think of one prayer you are holding. Write a short paragraph describing it as already answered, and how you feel now that it has happened.

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

DAY

4

Facing the Lion

I walk boldly up to the lion on my pathway and find it is a friendly airedale.

HAPPINESS

Name one thing you have been avoiding out of fear. Today, take one small step toward it: send the email, open the letter, make the call. Afterward, write down whether the "lion" was as fierce as you expected.

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

DAY

5

Unmoved by Appearances

I am undisturbed by appearances. I trust in God—and He now brings to me the desires of my heart.

MISCELLANEOUS

When something looks discouraging today, pause before reacting. Take three slow breaths and repeat the affirmation. Write down one situation where you chose calm over alarm.

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

DAY

6

Digging Your Ditches

I now dig my ditches deep with faith and understanding and my heart's desire comes to pass in a surprising way.

FAITH

Choose one hope and do something practical to prepare for it, as if it were already on the way. Clear space, gather information or set aside resources. Keep your preparation quiet for now.

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

DAY

7

Trusting the Dawn

It is dark before the dawn but the dawn never fails. Trust in the dawn.

WORDS OF WISDOM

Look back over your first week. Where did you feel a shift, even a small one? Write down one area that still feels dark, and write one sentence of trust about it.

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

DAY

8

Peace With Yourself

I am at peace with myself and with the whole world.

LOVE

Begin your week of relationships with yourself. Write down three things you appreciate about who you are. Say the affirmation in front of a mirror, looking yourself in the eye.

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

DAY

9

Love That Clears the Way

Divine Love, through me, now dissolves
all seeming obstacles and makes
clear, easy and successful my way.

LOVE

Think of one relationship that feels tense or stuck. Today, offer a small act of kindness to that person without expecting anything back. Notice how it changes your own feelings.

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

DAY

10

Forgiving Others

I forgive everyone and everyone forgives me. The gates swing open for my good.

FORGIVENESS

Write the name of someone you are ready to begin forgiving. You don't have to contact them or excuse what happened. Simply say the affirmation, picture them, and wish them well, even if only a little.

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

DAY

11

Forgiving Yourself

Though my mistakes be as scarlet, I shall be washed whiter than snow.

FORGIVENESS

Write down one mistake you still carry guilt about. If there is something you can do to make amends, plan it. Then say the affirmation slowly and allow yourself to release the rest.

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

DAY

12

Releasing Resentment

The Light of the Christ within now wipes out all fear, doubt, anger and resentment.

LOVE

Shinn believed resentment did great harm to body and home. Notice any flicker of irritation today. Each time, pause, picture light flooding the feeling, and repeat the affirmation.

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

DAY

13

The Way of Non-Resistance

Great peace have I who love thy law of nonresistance and nothing shall offend me.

MISCELLANEOUS

Remember Shinn's story of the woman who blessed "all the cousins in the Universe." Think of a pattern that keeps repeating in your relationships. Instead of resisting it, bless the people involved and let your irritation go.

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

DAY

14

Golden Links

Every man is a golden link in the chain of my good.

SUCCESS

List five people who have helped you, even in small ways, and include one you find difficult. Write how each might be a "golden link." Send a note of thanks to at least one of them.

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

DAY

15

Your Right Work

I am a perfect idea in Divine Mind and I am always in my right place doing my right work at the right time for the right pay.

MISCELLANEOUS

Write a description of the work that would feel truly right for you: what you do, with whom, and how it serves others. Circle one element you already have, and one you could move toward this month.

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

DAY

16

Open Doors

Unexpected doors fly open,
unexpected channels are free.

SUCCESS

Today, say yes to one small opportunity you might normally pass by: a conversation, an invitation, a new idea. Keep your eyes open for doors you didn't expect.

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

DAY

17

Money Without Fear

I spend money under direct inspiration wisely and fearlessly, knowing my supply is endless and immediate.

PROSPERITY

Look at your finances calmly today. Review one statement or bill without panic, bless it, and make one wise decision about it. Wisdom and fearlessness belong together.

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

DAY

18

Giving First

Giving precedes receiving and my gifts to others precede God's gifts to me.

SUCCESS

Give something today: time, attention, a small gift, a generous tip or a word of encouragement. Choose something within your means, and give it freely. Write down how giving felt.

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

DAY

19

Facing Obligations

All my obligations are now wiped out, under grace in a perfect way.

DEBT

Shinn's statement is about releasing fear and shame, not ignoring bills. Write a simple list of what you owe, say the affirmation, and take one practical step: a payment, a plan or a call for reputable advice.

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

DAY

20

Following Hunches

Hunches are my hounds of Heaven
—they lead me in the perfect way.

MISCELLANEOUS

Pay attention to quiet nudges today. Write down any hunch that comes, and act on one small, safe one. At the end of the day, note what happened.

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

DAY

21

Asking for Wisdom

Infinite Spirit, give me wisdom to make the most of my opportunities.

GUIDANCE

Write down one decision you are facing. Say the affirmation, then list your options without judging them. Sleep on it, and tomorrow morning notice which option feels clearest.

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

DAY

22

A Calm Mind

My poise is built upon a rock.
I see clearly and act quickly.

SUCCESS

Begin your final week with stillness. Sit quietly for five minutes, breathing slowly. Then say the affirmation and return to it whenever you feel rushed or rattled today.

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

DAY

23

Clearing Out the Old

I now let go of worn-out conditions and worn-out things.

SUCCESS

Clear out one drawer, shelf or closet. As you let go of things you no longer need, name one old habit of thought you are ready to release as well.

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

DAY

24

Joy and Interest

I live in the Kingdom of eternal joy and absorbing interests.

HEALTH

Do one thing today purely because it delights or absorbs you. Care for your body as well: rest, move, eat well. Remember that affirmations go alongside medical care, never in place of it.

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

DAY

25

Gratitude

My barns are full, my cup flows over with joy.

HAPPINESS

Write down twenty things you are thankful for, big and small. Read the list aloud, then say the affirmation. Keep the list somewhere you will see it this week.

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

DAY

26

Expecting Wonders

Nothing is too good to be true

MISCELLANEOUS

Notice where you brace for disappointment. Today, practice expecting good instead. Write down any small surprise or kindness that comes your way, however ordinary.

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

DAY

27

The Divine Pattern

My mind, body and affairs are now molded according to the Divine pattern within.

DIVINE DESIGN

Remember Shinn's image of the oak inside the acorn. Write about the person you sense you are meant to become. What qualities, work or relationships belong to that pattern?

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

DAY

28

Your Unique Place

I now fill the place that I can fill and no one else can fill.

DIVINE DESIGN

List three gifts or qualities that are uniquely yours. Think of one way to offer one of them this week, in your family, work or community. Stop comparing your path with anyone else's.

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

DAY

29

Looking Back

I am fully equipped for the Divine Plan of my life; I am more than equal to the situation.

DIVINE DESIGN

Read through your notebook from the past 28 days. Underline moments of change, insight or courage. Write down the two or three affirmations that meant the most to you, and why.

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

DAY

30

Commitment

I will not weary of well-doing, for when I least expect it I shall reap.

SUCCESS

Choose one affirmation to carry with you from now on. Write it on a card and place it where you will see it daily. Then write a short promise to yourself about how you will keep practicing, in words and in action.

TODAY I SPEAK

☐ spoken aloud ☐ written down ☐ one step taken

Affirmation Finder

Use this list when a particular situation is on your mind. Each line points to the chapters of Shinn's book that speak to it, and to the days of the 30-Day Practice where you will find a related affirmation and exercise.

When you feel anxious about money — Prosperity, Miscellaneous · Day 17

When bills or debts feel overwhelming — Debt, Prosperity · Day 19

When someone owes you money — Debt, Forgiveness · Day 10

Before a job interview — Interviews, Success · Day 16

When you are looking for your right work — Success, Divine Design · Day 15

When you are starting a business or creative project — Success, Faith · Day 6

When you are selling a house, car or belongings — Sales, Faith · Day 6

When you can't forgive someone — Forgiveness, Happiness · Day 10

When you can't forgive yourself — Forgiveness · Day 11

When resentment keeps coming back — Happiness, Miscellaneous · Day 12, Day 13

When you fear losing someone's love — Love, Marriage · Day 8, Day 9

When your relationship feels distant — Marriage, Love · Day 9

When you are hoping to meet the right partner — Marriage, Faith · Day 3

When fear is running the show — Your Word Is Your Wand, Protection, Faith · Day 4

When everything looks discouraging — Faith, Words of Wisdom · Day 5, Day 7

When you have a hunch but feel unsure — Words of Wisdom, Guidance · Day 20

When you face a hard decision — Guidance, Divine Design · Day 21

When you have lost something — Loss · Day 26

When you feel stuck or without purpose — Divine Design, Miscellaneous · Day 27, Day 28

When you keep comparing yourself to others — Divine Design, Interviews · Day 28

When you are tired, unwell or waiting on a diagnosis (always alongside your doctor's care) — Health, Anaemia, Heart Disease · Day 24

When you feel overwhelmed and need calm — Faith, Elements, Protection · Day 2, Day 22

Before a trip or a move — Journey · Day 16

When your pet is unwell or missing (alongside your vet's care) — Animals · Day 22

When you want to start the day with gratitude — Happiness, Your Word Is Your Wand · Day 1, Day 25

Afterword: Speaking a New Story

Nearly a hundred years have passed since Florence Scovel Shinn sat down to write this small book. The world she knew, with its fog-horns, Five and Ten Cent Stores and four-fifteen trains, has mostly disappeared. Yet her book is still read, copied into journals and spoken aloud in kitchens and cars every day. Why?

Part of the answer is that she understood something simple and lasting: we are always telling ourselves a story about our lives. "I never have enough." "Things never work out for me." "I'm not the kind of person who..." These sentences repeat so often that we stop noticing them. Shinn noticed. She asked her students to catch those old stories and replace them with new ones, spoken on purpose, in the present tense, with feeling.

You don't have to share every one of her beliefs to benefit from that practice. You may read her claims about health or money with more caution than she did, and that is wise. You may picture God differently, or use different language for the divine. Still, many readers find that choosing their words with care changes how they feel, and that how they feel changes what they are willing to try.

Notice, too, how often Shinn's stories involve action. The tearoom owner opened her shop. The woman with the room to rent bought the lamp. The woman selling her furniture polished it and pushed it to the middle of the room. The words came first, but the stories always kept going. Shinn called this "digging ditches," and it may be the most practical lesson in the book.

If you have finished the 30-Day Practice, you have already begun to speak a new story. Keep the affirmation that meant the most to you close at hand. Return to the chapters when life brings a new challenge. Be patient on the days the words feel hollow, and grateful on the days they ring true.

Shinn closed her book by trusting that her words would travel "unto the end of the world." In a small way, they have reached you. What you say next is up to you.

Further Reading

Other books by Florence Scovel Shinn

The Game of Life and How to Play It (1925)

The Secret Door to Success (1940)

The Power of the Spoken Word (1945)

Classic New Thought titles

Ralph Waldo Emerson, *Essays: First Series* (1841), including "Self-Reliance" and "The Over-Soul"

Prentice Mulford, *Thoughts Are Things* (1889)

Ralph Waldo Trine, *In Tune with the Infinite* (1897)

James Allen, *As a Man Thinketh* (1903)

Thomas Troward, *The Edinburgh Lectures on Mental Science* (1904)

Wallace D. Wattles, *The Science of Getting Rich* (1910)

Wallace D. Wattles, *The Science of Being Well* (1910)

Thomas Troward, *The Hidden Power* (1921)